



JANUARY 2015

CARIBBEAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL
CARIBBEAN SECONDARY EDUCATION CERTIFICATE®
EXAMINATION

SOCIAL STUDIES

Paper 032 – General Proficiency

1 hour 10 minutes

READ THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS CAREFULLY.

1. This paper consists of FIVE questions. You **MUST** answer **ALL** questions on this paper.
2. Write your answers in the spaces provided in this answer booklet.
3. Do **NOT** write in the margins.
4. You are advised to take some time to read through the paper and plan your answers.
5. If you need to rewrite an answer and there is not enough space to do so on the original page, you must use the extra lined page(s) provided at the back of this booklet. **Remember to draw a line through your original answer and correctly number your new answer in the box provided.**
6. If you use the extra pages you **MUST** write the question number clearly in the box provided at the top of the extra page(s) and, where relevant, include the question part beside the answer.

DO NOT TURN THIS PAGE UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.

Before you write your answers, choose ONE of the research topics below and write it in the space provided. You will be required to answer Questions 1, 2 and 3 based on the topic you have chosen.

TOPICS:

- (i) The major effects of social media on youth in my community.
- (ii) Parents' views on the sale of only healthy foods and snacks in school cafeterias

Topic Chosen:

1. (a) State ONE reason why you would want to investigate the topic you have chosen.

.....
.....
(2 marks)

- (b) Write a problem statement based on the topic you have chosen. Begin your statement with the following:

The study will

.....
.....
(2 marks)

- (c) Identify ONE term that you would define in your study.

.....
(1 mark)

- (d) Questionnaires may be used to gather information for a study. Identify TWO other research instruments that you could use to gather information on the topic you have chosen.

(i)
(ii)
(2 marks)

- (e) State TWO problems a researcher may experience in gathering data from questionnaires.

(i)
.....
(ii)
.....
(2 marks)

Total 9 marks

2. (a) State ONE research question for the topic of your choice in Question 1.

.....

.....

(1 mark)

- (b) Write THREE questions for a questionnaire that you would use to gather data on the topic you have chosen. Questions should address the relevant variables and should be arranged in the ORDER they would appear on the questionnaire.

(i)

.....

.....

(ii)

.....

.....

(iii)

.....

.....

(4 marks)

Total 5 marks

3. (a) Describe an appropriate method which could be used to select the sample for the research study.

Method

.....

Description of method

.....

.....

.....

(2 marks)

- (b) Give ONE reason for selecting the method of sampling described in (a) above.

.....

.....

.....

(2 marks)

- (c) In research it is ethical for the researcher to protect the members of the sample from danger or harm.

State TWO ways by which you, the researcher, would protect the members of the sample from danger or harm.

(i)

.....

.....

(ii)

.....

.....

(2 marks)

Total 6 marks

Questions 4 and 5 are based on the following case study. Answer BOTH questions.

Gretchen Mier Secondary School is a co-educational institution situated in the poor seaside town of Langle. The school has a student population of 1,500 and records low graduation rates among the students each year. In 2009, only 46 per cent of the students completed school and graduated. It was estimated that over the last ten years approximately 3,000 students have dropped out of the school.

Out of concern, the principal hired a team of researchers to investigate the reasons for the high dropout rate. The researchers distributed questionnaires to a sample of 320 dropouts in the town. Three hundred completed questionnaires were returned and analysed.

The data revealed the following: 38 per cent of the sample was more interested in 'sea life' than in school; 25 per cent could not afford school supplies; 19 per cent had too many chores to do at home; 12 per cent felt that school did not treat all students fairly and 6 per cent expressed dislike for their teachers.

The researchers documented their findings and presented them at a special staff meeting. Following the presentation, the principal asked staff members to make recommendations to improve the situation so that the graduation rates would increase in the future.

4. (a) State the MAIN focus of the investigation conducted by the researchers.

.....
.....

(2 marks)

- (b) State ONE fact about Gretchen Mier Secondary School that the researchers took into consideration in selecting the sample.

.....
.....

(1 mark)

- (c) State why the fact you gave in (b) above was important to the researchers.

.....
.....

(1 mark)

- (d) State TWO important findings of the investigation conducted by the researchers.

Finding 1:

.....

Finding 2:

.....

(2 marks)

Total 6 marks

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

5. (a) (i) The table below presents data collected from the research. Calculate the missing frequencies and insert them in the blank spaces in the table.

Reasons for not Graduating	Percentage	Frequency
Prefer 'sea life'	38	
Unable to afford school supplies	25	75
Too many chores at home	19	57
Unfair treatment at school	12	
Dislike for teachers	6	18
Total	100	300

←

←

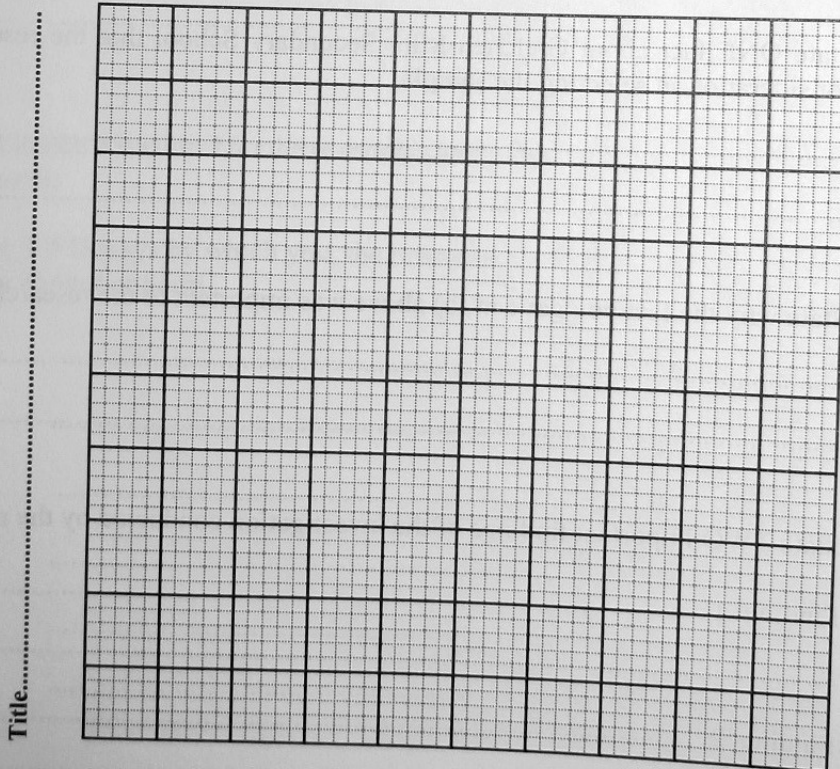
(2 marks)

- (ii) In the grid provided below, draw a bar graph to represent the data collected by the researchers.

You will be awarded marks for the following:

- Providing an appropriate title
- Labelling each axis
- Bars accurately drawn and correctly labelled

Title.....



Title.....

(5 marks)

- (b) Write TWO interpretations based on the data you have displayed in the bar graph in Question 5 (a) (ii).
(Remember to make use of research terms where necessary.)

Interpretation 1:

.....

.....

Interpretation 2:

.....

.....

(2 marks)

- (c) State TWO recommendations the researchers could make to improve the rate of graduation.

(i)

.....

(ii)

.....

(4 marks)

- (d) State ONE implementation strategy for one of the the recommendations you identified in (c) above.

Implementation strategy

.....

.....

.....

(1 mark)

Total 14 marks

END OF TEST

IF YOU FINISH BEFORE TIME IS CALLED, CHECK YOUR WORK ON THIS TEST.